Historical source

Encyclopaedia Britannica scan, source row 2570. Parse 3.5 extracted the text. Super 3.5 VL corrected it from an enlarged crop of each block. It can still contain recognition errors. Page headers, footers, and page numbers are removed.

ABYSSINIA (E0249)

Continues an entry from an earlier page.

Abyssinia.

The new emperor intends to revenge his death.

Execution of the queen and other regicides.

Tigi revolts, but is defeated, taken, and put to death.

Lice of So- lonon set aside.

and a stranger of the name of Outsas seated on the Abyssinian throne. The extreme severity of Theophilus in punishing the murderers of both Yasous and Tecla Haimanout gave occasion to this; for as both princes had been assassinated in consequence of conspiracies formed by the principal people of the nation, the number of conspirators was so great, that the parties concerned had interest sufficient to influence the election of the new monarch, even in this most capital respect, of his not being a descendant of Solomon. Excepting this single defect, he was in every respect worthy of

the kingdom, and was already the highest subject in it. Abyssinia. Scarce was he seated on the throne, however, when a

Source: was he seated on the throne, however, when a dangerous conspiracy was formed against him by the very person by whom he had been placed upon it. Oustas baffled their designs, by seizing the principal conspirators before they had time to bring their schemes to a bearing: and several people of the first rank were condemned to lose their noses, or to be put to death. After this the emperor undertook an expedition against the Shangalla, according to the barbarous custom of the Abyssinian monarchs, who hunt these poor people merely for the sake of making slaves; slaughtering the men without mercy, as well as many of the women, and carrying off only the boys and girls into captivity. In this he met with perfect success; and was about to attempt the conquest of the whole country, when he was called back by the news that his prime minister Tafa Christos was dead. While the emperor remained in his capital at Gondar, he was taken suddenly ill; which he imputed at first to witchcraft, and therefore used some antidotes; among which the smoking of the palace with gunpowder was one. But this was done so carelessly by the servants, that the whole building was consumed; an accident looked upon by the people in general as a very bad omen, especially as the king's complaint increased every day. At last the principal officers came to pay him a visit of condolence, as they pretended; but in reality to observe the nature of his distemper, and to consult whether or not it was likely to continue till they could fall upon means to deprive him of the government. Oustas understood their intentions, and therefore summoned all his strength to assume for a moment the appearance of health; so that the officers found him as usual engaged in business. Being thus disconcerted, it became necessary to make some apology for a visit so extraordinary and formal; for which they were at first somewhat at a loss; on recollection, however, they told him, that hearing he had been sick, which they happily found was not the case, they had come to make a proposal concerning the succession; professing a desire that he would quiet the minds of his own family, and of the people in general, by appointing his son Fasil successor to the throne after his decease. Oustas gave them an equivocal answer; but the discourse concerning Fasil happening to be overheard by the soldiers, a violent mutiny ensued, and all the officers who had come to visit Oustas were killed. Part of the town was set on fire in the confusion; and at last a proclamation was made, that David son of Yasous was king of Abyssinia. The prince was then sent for from the mountain, and arriving at Gondar, was crowned on the 30th of January 1714. The distemper of Oustas, in the mean time continuing to increase, he died on the 10th of February the same year.

The new emperor was a rigid Alexandrian in prin- ciple; but Oustas had been so far favourable to the David. Catholics as to entertain some of their priests, though in a private manner. As it was the custom, however, to call a convocation of the clergy on the accession of every new emperor, the monks and others insisted up- on one being called on the present occasion; the more especially that a new Abuna was come from Egypt, and the lenity shewn to the Catholics by Oustas had excited the jealousy of the Abyssinian clergy in the highest

Source record

Scan ID `britannica:309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443:train:2570`

Image file page-2570-364adfefc0b1.jpg

Image SHA-256 364adfefc0b17833777e04973fd5d32fe490446622be257cba01f40a110e77ae

Dataset NationalLibraryOfScotland/encyclopaedia_britannica_illustrated at revision 309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443 (CC0-1.0)

Extraction model nvidia/nemotron-3.5-parse, raw reply extract/raw/page-2570-364adfefc0b1.json

Raw reply SHA-256 c0b5b889df8c057cf05ebb082e3902dd082a4b1a54a53facf4fb229adb78b5a6

Correction model nvidia/Nemotron-3.5-Super-VL, block crops, raw replies correct/raw/crop_nothink/page-2570-364adfefc0b1-b*.json; super_vl: 9

Running header 88 ABYSSINIA.